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Week-10

Chapter # 06

The Social System of Islam

The Islamic Social System is the framework of social relationships and structures established according to the teachings of Islam, derived from the Qur'an, the Sunnah, Ijma' (consensus of scholars), and Qiyas (analogy). It governs how individuals interact with one another in society, aiming to create a balanced, just, and moral community that ensures both spiritual and social well-being.

Concept of the Islamic Social System

Islam is not merely a religion confined to rituals and acts of worship; rather, it is a complete code of life that provides comprehensive guidance for every sphere of human existence — spiritual, moral, social, political, and economic. Unlike other faith traditions that may separate the sacred from the secular, Islam integrates both dimensions, shaping the conduct of individuals and societies alike (Al-Qur'an, 6:162–163). The Islamic concept of worship (*'ibadah*) extends far beyond performing prayers or fasting; it encompasses all actions undertaken with sincerity and in accordance with divine commands. As the Qur'an declares:

“Say, indeed my prayer, my rites of sacrifice, my living and my dying are for Allah, Lord of the worlds” (Qur'an 6:162).

Thus, Islam offers a 24-hour framework for life, directing how one should think, act, and interact with others — from personal hygiene and business dealings to governance and social justice. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH exemplified this all-inclusive approach, guiding his followers through his sayings and actions (*Sunnah*) on how to lead a life grounded in righteousness, balance, and purpose.

The concept is rooted in the principle that all human beings are equal before Allah, differing only in piety and righteousness. The system's purpose is to organize society in a way that promotes justice, compassion, cooperation, and social harmony, while preventing exploitation, oppression, and moral decay.

The Islamic social system revolves around the belief that every individual has rights and duties toward others — family, neighbors, community, and the state — and that fulfilling these responsibilities leads to social stability and collective prosperity.

The benefits of Islamic social system can be summarized as follows:

- 1. Promotes justice and equality among all individuals.**
- 2. Strengthens family and community bonds.**
- 3. Eliminates poverty through Zakat, Sadaqah, and Waqf.**
- 4. Uplifts moral and ethical values in society.**
- 5. Fosters unity, harmony, and brotherhood among people.**
- 6. Protects the rights of men, women, and minorities.**

7. Ensures psychological and emotional well-being.
8. Prevents social evils such as corruption, adultery, and intoxication.
9. Encourages mutual responsibility and cooperation.
10. Creates a peaceful, balanced, and prosperous society.

The Noble Status and Spiritual Worth of Humanity in Islam

Islam grants the highest possible value to human life and the soul, regarding both as sacred trusts bestowed by Allah. The Qur'an and Sunnah affirm that every human being is created with inherent honour, dignity, and purpose, reflecting the divine spirit breathed into them. This divine origin makes life inviolable, and its protection a central moral duty. Islam does not measure a person's worth by wealth, status, or lineage, but by their righteousness and moral conduct. The faith teaches that to harm a single innocent life is equivalent to harming all of humanity, while saving one life is like saving all mankind — a principle that shows how profoundly Islam upholds the sanctity, respect, and spiritual value of every human soul.

Divine Honour of Humanity

Allah declares in the Qur'an:

“And indeed, We have honoured the children of Adam...” (Surah Al-Isra, 17:70)

This verse affirms that every human being—regardless of race, class, or gender—is born with inherent honour and dignity. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH further emphasized this, saying:

All of you are from Adam, and Adam was created from dust.” (Sunan al-Tirmidhi, # 3955)

This Hadith eliminates all forms of racial or social superiority, reinforcing equality as a divine principle.

The Sacred Nature of the Soul

The Qur'an describes the soul (nafs) as originating from Allah's own command:

“Then He proportioned him and breathed into him of His spirit.” (Surah As-Sajdah, 32:9)

This divine act grants every human life an element of spiritual sanctity. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH said:

“The soul of the believer is a pearl—precious to Allah.”

(Musnad Ahmad, # 23936)

Thus, life itself is a sacred manifestation of divine will, and no one has the right to take it unjustly.

Sanctity and Protection of Life

The Qur'an strictly prohibits the unjust killing of any soul:

“Whoever kills a person unjustly, it is as if he has killed all mankind...” (Surah Al-Ma'idah, 5:32)

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH reinforced this by declaring during his Farewell Sermon:

“Your blood, your property, and your honour are sacred to you, like the sanctity of this day, in this month, in this city.”

(Sahih al-Bukhari, # 1739; Sahih Muslim, # 1679)

This statement made at 'Arafat' serves as the foundation for human rights and social ethics in Islam.

Equality and Moral Accountability

Islam teaches that all souls are equal in essence, and superiority comes only through piety (taqwa):

“The most honoured of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you.” (Surah Al-Hujurat, 49:13)

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH echoed this teaching:

“No Arab has superiority over a non-Arab, nor a non-Arab over an Arab; no white over a black, nor a black over a white—except by piety.”

(Musnad Ahmad, # 22978)

This universal equality ensures respect, justice, and brotherhood among all people.

Protection of Human Dignity

Islam considers preservation of life and dignity among the primary objectives (Maqasid al-Shari'ah) of Islamic law. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH said:

“Breaking the bone of a dead person is like breaking it when he is alive.”

(Sunan Abu Dawood, # 3207)

This Hadith shows that human dignity remains inviolable even after death, underscoring Islam's unmatched reverence for human life.

Comprehensive Protection of Life

Prophet Muhammad PBUH warned against any act that violates another's right to life or dignity:

“A Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hand other Muslims are safe.”

(Sahih al-Bukhari, # 10)

This hadith sets a universal ethical standard—peace, security, and respect for others are integral to faith itself.

The Sanctity of Marriage

Marriage in Islam is far more than a legal contract or social arrangement; it is a sacred bond designed to foster love, mercy, responsibility, and spiritual growth. The Qur'an and Sunnah emphasize that marriage is a vital institution that contributes to both personal fulfillment and the betterment of society. It is regarded as an act of worship and a Sunnah (tradition) of the Prophet Muhammad PBUH. Marriage is not only recommended but also obligatory for those who are capable, as it helps preserve chastity and promotes a stable social order. Allah, the Almighty, has mentioned in the Qur'an that marriage is a sacred bond.

“And among His signs is this: that He created for you spouses from among yourselves so that you may find tranquility in them, and He has placed between you affection and mercy. Surely in this are signs for those who reflect.”

(Surah Al-Rum 30:21)

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has emphasized the significance of marriage in the following words.

“Marriage is part of my Sunnah, and whoever does not follow my Sunnah has nothing to do with me.” (Ibn Majah, 1846; Sahih)

Rights of Wife

The rights of a wife in Islam hold great significance as they reflect the religion's deep commitment to justice, compassion, and balance within family life. Islam recognizes the wife as an equal partner, deserving of love, respect, and dignity. Her rights to consent in marriage, financial maintenance (nafaqah), mahr (dowry), kind treatment, and protection from harm are clearly outlined in the Qur'an and Sunnah. These rights ensure that marriage is not merely a social contract but a sacred partnership based on mercy and mutual care. By safeguarding the honour and well-being of women, Islam promotes family harmony and social stability, making the home a place of peace and spiritual growth.

The Right to Marriage Consent

This is the fundamental prerequisite or right of a woman before marriage. A marriage is invalid without the free consent of the bride—expressed either explicitly or implicitly. Guardians cannot force her into marriage. This ruling has been discussed in multiple narrations. It has been categorically mentioned in the Quran:

O believers! It is not permissible for you to inherit women against their will. Al-Nisa: 19

“If any woman marries without the consent of her guardian, her marriage is void.” (Sunan Abu Dawood, Ibn Majah, Tirmidhi)

It has been narrated on the authority of Khansa bint Khidam Al-Ansariya : that her father gave her in marriage when she was a matron and she disliked that marriage. So, she went to Allah's Apostle ﷺ and he declared that marriage invalid.

It has been narrated on the authority of Abdullah ibn Abbas: A virgin came to the Prophet PBUH and mentioned that her father had married her against her will, so the Prophet PBUH allowed her to exercise her choice.

Right to Mahr (Dowry)

A mandatory gift from the husband to the wife at the time of marriage. It belongs solely to the wife and is hers to spend or keep.

“And give the women [upon marriage] their dowries as a gracious gift...” (Surah An-Nisā 4:4)

Right to Financial Maintenance (Nafaqah)

The husband is obligated to provide for his wife's housing, food, clothing, medical care, and general well-being, according to his means.

“And let those of you who are rich spend according to their means ...” (Surah Al-Talaq 65:7)

“Their food and clothing are incumbent on the father on a reasonable basis...” (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:233)

Hadith:

Jabir narrated that the Prophet said in his Farewell Sermon:

“Fear Allah concerning women!... Their rights upon you are that you should provide them with food and clothing in a fitting manner.” (Sahih Muslim 1218)

Narrated Sad bin Abi Waqqas: Allah's Apostle PBUH said,

"You will be rewarded for whatever you spend for Allah's sake even if it were a morsel which you put in your wife's mouth." (Sahih Bukhari: 56)

Right to Kind Treatment & Respect

A wife must be treated with compassion, dignity, kindness, and patience at all times. this is commanded in the Quran in the following words:

“And live with them in kindness...” (Surah An-Nisā 4:19)

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has lived a very kind and respectful life with her wives. He has taught the Muslims to be kind and loving with the wives and mentioned it as an essential source of Divine pleasure.

“The best of you are those who are best to their wives.” (Sunan Al-Tirmidhi).

Some of the incidents of his bonding with the wives are narrated as follows.

Narrated by Aisha :

That Allah's Apostle PBUH said to her, "I became aware when you are pleased with me or angry with me." I said, "Whence do you know that?" He said, "When you are pleased with me, you say, No, by the Lord of Muhammad, but when you are angry with me, then you say, No, by the Lord of Abraham. " Thereupon I said, "Yes (you are right), but by Allah, O Allah's Apostle, I leave nothing but your name."

Taking Your Wife Out for a Meal — Reviving the Sunnah of Affection

Anas reported that Allah's Messenger PBUH had a neighbor who was Persian (by descent), and he was expert in the preparation of soup. He prepared (soup) for Allah's Messenger ﷺ and then came to him to invite him (to that feast). He (Allah's Messenger) said: Here is Aisha also (and you should also invite her to the food). He said: No. Thereupon Allah's Messenger PBUH also said: No (then I cannot join the feast). He returned inviting him, and Allah's Messenger PBUH said: She is also there (i. e. Aisha should also be invited). He said: No. Thereupon, Allah's Messenger PBUH also said: No (and declined his offer). He returned again to invite him and Allah's Messenger PBUH again said: She is also there. He (the host) said: "Yes" for the third time. Then he accepted his invitation, and both of them set out until they came to his house. (Sahih Muslim:5312)

Spending quality time with wives is Sunnah

Narrated by Aisha, Ummul Muminin: while she was on a journey along with the Messenger of Allah: I had a race with him (the Prophet) and I outstripped him on my feet. When I became fleshy, (again) I had a race with him (the Prophet) and he outstripped me. He said: This is for that outstripping. (Sunan Abu Dawud: 2578)

Right to Dignity & Protection from Harm

Physical or emotional abuse is strictly prohibited in Islam, as it goes against the principles of kindness and respect in a marriage. A wife has – at all times – the right to be treated respectfully and live free from fear. It has been mentioned multiple times in the Quran. The relationship of marriage has been established in the name of Allah so you should always fear Allah.

Prophetic Teaching:

In his Farewell Sermon, the Prophet PBUH warned:

“If she allows a man you dislike into the bed [house], you may gently chastise her—but not oppressively. But her rights upon you are food, attire, and kindness.” (Sahih Muslim)

Right to Spiritual and Emotional Companionship & Mutual Consultation

This is the true essence and purpose of marriage. It is a bond of mutual peace, mercy, and emotional support, encouraging joint decision-making and shared moral life.

“And among His signs is that He created for you spouses from among yourselves, that you may find tranquility in them; and He placed between your affection and mercy.” (Surah Al-Rūm 30:21)

Narrated by Al-Aswad : That he asked Aisha "What did the Prophet ﷺ use to do in his house?" She replied, "He used to keep himself busy serving his family, he was so kind and helpful that we used to forget that he is the Prophet of Allah and when it was the time for prayer he would go for it."

Helping in every kind of household was the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad a. All the believers should follow this Sunnah in true essence and facilitate their spouses in every aspect.

Rights of Husband

In Islam, the rights of a husband hold great significance as they form the foundation of a balanced and harmonious family life. The Qur'an and Sunnah emphasize mutual respect, love, and cooperation between spouses, while recognizing the husband's role as the protector, maintainer, and leader of the household. Allah says, "*Men are the protectors and maintainers of women...*" (Surah An-Nisā 4:34). This responsibility is not a privilege of dominance but a duty of care, guidance, and compassion. A righteous wife is encouraged to honour her husband, support him, and maintain peace in the home. By fulfilling each other's rights, both husband and wife achieve spiritual growth, emotional stability, and the pleasure of Allah.

Respect and Obedience

The first and foremost right of a husband is to be respected by his wife. In Islam, a wife is expected to show her husband respect and obedience, as long as his demands are within the boundaries of Islamic principles. This does not mean blind obedience, but rather the understanding that the husband has a leadership role within the family, and that role comes with rights and responsibilities.

The Quran addresses the relationship between spouses and speaks about the husband's leadership role:

"Men are the protectors and maintainers of women because Allah has made one of them to excel over the other, and because they spend of their wealth (for the support of women)." (Quran 4:34)

This verse highlights that men are given a position of responsibility in marriage, and it is essential for the wife to recognize his leadership in the family, ensuring that the household runs smoothly and harmoniously.

Good Treatment and Kindness

The relationship between a husband and wife is based on love and kindness. A husband has the right to be treated with care, affection, and kindness. The Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) emphasized the importance of treating one's spouse with gentleness, stating:

"The best of you are those who are the best to their wives." (Tirmidhi)

Islam urges both husbands and wives to treat each other with compassion and understanding? The Quran further supports this:

"And live with them in kindness. For if you dislike them – perhaps you dislike a thing and Allah makes therein much good." (Quran 4:19)

The husband has the right to expect kind treatment from his wife, who in turn should always strive to maintain a loving, peaceful home.

Preserving the Husband's Honor and Dignity

In Islam, preserving the honor and dignity of one's spouse is of paramount importance. The husband has the right to expect his wife to protect his reputation, both in his presence and in his absence. This means that she should not share private or personal matters with others and should act with modesty and respect.

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH emphasized the importance of preserving one's dignity and privacy:

"If a man and a woman are alone, the third one among them is the devil." (Sunan Ibn Majah)

This highlights the need for confidentiality and the preservation of personal boundaries.

Emotional Support and Companionship

A husband has the right to emotional support and companionship from his wife. The marital relationship in Islam is not limited to material or physical needs but also involves emotional intimacy. Both partners are expected to provide comfort and encouragement to each other.

The Quran describes the relationship between husband and wife as one of tranquility and peace:

"And of His signs is that He created for you from yourselves mates that you may find tranquility in them..." (Quran 30:21)

A husband has the right to expect that his wife will offer him emotional support, reassurance, and companionship, especially in times of difficulty.

Loyalty and Faithfulness

Loyalty and faithfulness are foundational to any successful marriage. The husband has the right to expect his wife to be faithful, and in return, he must also show loyalty. Infidelity is considered a serious violation in Islam, as it undermines the integrity of the marital bond.

The Quran explicitly states:

"And those who guard their chastity, except from their wives or those their right hands possess, for indeed, they are not to be blamed." (Quran 23:5-6)

This verse makes it clear that the wife is expected to remain loyal to her husband, safeguarding the sanctity of the marriage.

Right of Gratitude

This is the religious obligation of the wives that they should be grateful to their husbands for their efforts and conduct. The Apostle of Allah has taught the significance of gratitude in following words.

I saw Hell also. No such (abominable) sight have I ever seen as that which I saw today; and I observed that most of its inhabitants were women. They said: Messenger of Allah, on what account is it so? He said: For their ingratitude or disbelief. It was asked: Do they disbelieve in Allah? He said: (Not for their disbelief in God) but for their ingratitude to their husbands and ingratitude to kindness. If you were to treat one of them kindly forever, but if she later saw anything (displeasing) in you, she would say: I have never seen any good in you. (Sahih Muslim: 2109)

Rights of Parents

The rights of parents hold a place of exceptional importance in Islam, second only to the worship of Allah. The Qur'an repeatedly commands believers to show kindness, gratitude, and obedience to their parents, especially to the mother, who endures hardship in pregnancy and upbringing. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH also emphasized this duty, saying that pleasing one's parents earns Allah's pleasure, while disobeying them earns His anger. Serving parents, speaking gently, caring for them in old age, and making dua for them even after their death are all acts of worship in Islam. Thus, Islam elevates the status of parents to one of the highest moral and spiritual responsibilities, making honouring them a key to Paradise.

Treat Parents with Benevolence

وَقَضَىٰ رَبُّكَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَانًا

And your Lord has commanded you not to worship anyone other than Allah and treat the parents with benevolence. (Surah Al-Isrā, 17:23)

This is a very significant point that Allah the Almighty has mentioned the ruling of benevolence with parents adjacent to His tawhid in the same. One can understand the esteemed status of parents with this verse. This practice has been repeated in the Quran several times. Allah the Almighty wants to make this clear that after My worship reverence of the parents is one of the most significant commandments.

وَاعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَلَا تُشْرِكُوا بِهِ شَيْئًا وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَانًا

And worship Allah and do not set up any partners with Him and treat the parents with moral excellence. (Sura al-Nisa 4:36)

It is important to clarify that this commandment has been established since the time of the Prophet Adam PBUH and that it has continued to the time of final Prophet, Muhammad PBUH.

وَإِذْ أَخَذْنَا مِيثَاقَ بَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ لَا تَعْبُدُونَ إِلَّا اللَّهَ وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَانًا

And (remember) when We took a firm promise from the Children of Ya'qub (Jacob): 'Do not worship (anyone) besides Allah, and be nice to the parents. (Surah Al-Baqarah 2:83)

Kindness with parents is one of the best deeds in the sight of Allah.

It is reported on the authority of Abdullah that the Apostle of Allah PBUH observed: The best of the deeds or deed is the (observance of) prayer at its proper time and kindness to the parents.

Taking care of Parents in Old age

إِنَّمَا يَنْبَغُ عِنْدَكَ الْكِبَرُ أَحَدُهُمَا أَوْ كِلَاهُمَا فَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا قَوْلًا كَرِهًا

If either or both of them attain to old age in your presence, then do not say even ‘Ugh!’ to them nor reproach them. And always speak to both of them submissively, observing polite manners. (Surah Al-Isrā, 17:23-24)

Allah the Almighty has associated this commandment with old age of parents. He has mentioned that not to even use the word “Uff” in front of them. We need to understand the point mentioned in the verse. Uff is not even a proper word and it has no meaning. It is just a sign of frustration and irritation. Allah has stopped us from using this kind of word so that we can contemplate that misbehave and loud voice is strictly prohibited. As per hadith of the Prophet Muhammad PBUH our conduct with parents in old age will decide our destiny.

Abu Hurairah g reported Allah’s Apostle PBUH as saying: Let him be humbled into dust; let him be humbled into dust. It was said: Allah’s Messenger, who is he? He said: He who sees either of his parents during their old age or he sees both of them, but he does not enter Paradise.

This is the testing time of children to take care of them in old age. Only a person who obeys Allah can take of parents in a good manner.

Pray for Parents

In the next verse another commandment has been given to the children. It is the duty of children to supplicate in the court of Allah for their parents.

وَاخْفِضْ لَهُمَا جَنَاحَ الذُّلِّ مِنَ الرَّحْمَةِ وَقُلْ رَبِّ ارْحَمْهُمَا كَمَا رَبَّيَانِي صَغِيرًا

And always lower your arms of submissiveness and humility out of soft-heartedness for both of them and keep supplicating (Allah): ‘O my Lord, have mercy on both of them as they brought me up in (my) childhood (with mercy and clemency).’ (Surah Al-Isrā, 17:23-24)

Allah the Almighty has reminded us that when we were infants our parents take care of us. We were not able to perform anything and help ourselves. Both the parents but particularly mother has borne a lot of pain during pregnancy and delivery.

وَوَصَّيْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ بِوَالِدَيْهِ حَلَالَتُهُ أُمُّهُ وَهَيْئًا عَلَىٰ وَهْنٍ وَفِصَالُهُ فِي عَامَيْنِ

And We enjoined upon man emphatically (to do good) in relation to his parents — whose mother bore him (in her reproductive system) in pain after pain, (Sura Luqman: 14)

Same point has been mentioned in Sura al-Ahqaf verse 15. Parents helped and raised us with extreme care and unconditional love. They have helped the children in every phase of their lives. Nothing can be the compensation of this unconditional love. This is the utmost duty of children to take care of them in the old age when they are weak.

Be Grateful to parents

Allah the Almighty has directed us to always remain grateful to Him and parents. He has merged the right of His gratitude with parents in the following verse.

أَنِ اشْكُرْ لِي وَلِوَالِدَيْكَ إِلَيَّ الْمَصِيرُ

Be grateful to Me and to your parents.

The person who is not grateful to his parents from the core of heart can never be grateful to Allah in true sense.

Obedience of Parents

A person should always be obedient to his parents. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has regarded disobedience of parents one of the greatest sins after the shirk of Allah.

Anas narrated from the Apostle Muhammad PBUH about the major sins. He (the Holy Prophet) observed: Associating anyone with Allah, disobedience to parents, killing a person and false utterance.

One should never Abuse his parents

The Holy Prophet Muhammad PBUH guided his companions that a person should never abuse his parents. The Companions asked how a person can abuse his own parents. He replied:

“Yes, one abuses the father of another man, who in turn abuses his father. One abuses his mother and he in turn abuses his (the formers) mother.” (Sahih Muslim:263)

The right of Mother is 75%

It was narrated that Abu Hurairah said: “They said: O Messenger of Allah, whom should I treat kindly? He said: Your mother. He said: Then who? He said: Your mother.” He said: Then who? He said: Your father: He said: Then who? He said: The next closest and the next closest”. (Sunan Ibn Maja: 3658)

Father is the door of Janah

It was narrated that Abu Darda heard the Prophet Muhammad PBUH say: “The father is the middle door of Paradise, middle door of Paradise (i.e., the best way to Paradise), so it is up to you whether you take advantage of it or not.”

In another hadith the Prophet Muhammad PBUH said:

You and your money belong to you father. (Sunan Ibn Maja:2291)

Rights of Children

Allah the Almighty has provided rights to every individual of a family. He has emphasized the rights of parents in the Quran and Hadith in great which has been discussed earlier. He has also guided us about the rights of infants and children in the Quran and Hadith. Some of the most important rights are mentioned as follows:

Right to Life:

It is the right of a child that it should be given birth once conceived in the womb of mother. Allah the Almighty has categorically declared killing of a child as one of the biggest sins.

وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ خَشْيَةَ إِمْلَاقٍ نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُهُمْ وَإِيَّاكُمْ إِنَّ قَتْلَهُمْ كَانَ خِطْئًا كَبِيرًا

اور تم اپنی اولاد کو مفلسی کے خوف سے قتل مت کرو، ہم ہی انہیں (بھی) روزی دیتے ہیں اور تمہیں بھی، بیشک ان کو قتل کرنا بہت بڑا گناہ ہے

And do not kill your children due to fear of poverty. We alone provide for them and for you (as well). Indeed, killing them is a major sin. (Surah Al-Isrā, 17:31)

A similar commandment is also found in:

“And do not kill your children for fear of poverty. We provide for them and for you. Indeed, their killing is ever a great sin.”

(Surah Al-An‘ām, 6:151)

It was asked by the Prophet PBUH, “What is the greatest sin in the Sight of Allah?” He said, “That you set up a rival unto Allah though He Alone created you.” I said, “That is indeed a great sin.” Then asked, “What is next?” He said, “To kill your son lest he should share your food with you.” Sahih Bukhari 4477

Right to Food

Allah the Almighty has declared His responsibility to feed them. He has fed them in the womb of the mother. Only He was able to provide food and all other mechanisms in it. He has also provided milk for the first 2 years. He is the one who has created all the means of provisions. This is the duty of the parents to find ways income provide them with good food. They should to do efforts to enhance their source of income.

نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُهُمْ وَإِيَّاكُمْ

ہم ہی انہیں (بھی) روزی دیتے ہیں اور تمہیں بھی،

We alone provide for them and for you (as well).

Right of Genealogy

This is also one the basic right of a child that his parents provide him a proper ancestry. Allah the Almighty has commanded us to use the name of biological father with son even

though he is adopted. The explanation of this concept has been mentioned in Sura Al-Ahzab verse 5.

Right of Good name

Giving good name to is also their right. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH changed name of some person who have bad meanings.

Ibn Umar reported that Allah's Messenger PBUH changed the name of Asiya (Disobedient) and said: You are Jamila (i. e. good and handsome). Ahmad (one of the narrators) narrated it with a slight variation of wording. Sahih Muslim: 5604

Right of good brought-up

This is the duty of parents to do good brought-up of their children. Provide them with good food, clothes and all other necessities of life. This is also their right to provide them with good mental and emotional brought-up as well. Inculcate in them good morals and knowledge and teach them how to differentiate between right and wrong. Particularly Muslims are supposed to instill Islamic concepts with clarity to their children so that they become conceptual Muslims.

Virtues of Daughter's brought-up

The Prophet Muhammad a has exclusively mentioned the virtues of daughters brought-up. All the parents do the brought-up of their daughters but in that era, there was no rights of daughters and they were disregarded. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH grant them respect and reverence.

Uqbah bin Amir said: I heard the Messenger of Allah PBUH say: 'Whoever has three daughters and is patient towards them, and feeds them, gives them to drink, and clothes them from his wealth; they will be a shield for him from the Fire on the Day of Resurrection.' In another narration some text has been mentioned for two and one daughter as well. Sunan Ibn Maja:3669 & 3670

A woman entered upon Sayyeda Aisha with her two daughters, and she gave her three dates. (The woman) gave each of her daughters a date, then she split the last one between them. Sayyeda Aisha said: Then the Prophet PBUH came and I told him about that. He said: Why are you surprised? She will enter Paradise because of that. Sunan Ibn Maja:3668

It was narrated from Suraqah bin Malik that the Prophet PBUH said: "Shall I not tell you of the best charity? He said whatever you spent on your daughter will be considered as best charity in the sight of Allah" Sunan Ibn Maja:3668

Right to Love

This is the right of children that they should be provided extreme love and care. We should become a child with children as our Prophet Muhammad PBUH himself do throughout his life. He used to prolong the Sajda of prayer while he was Imam of the congregation just to facilitate children. He used to start distribution in his gathering from children. It was his habit to play with children in the streets of Madina. He has performed all these acts in that

era where children were never treated with love, care and respect. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH guided us that treating children with love is the sign of Allah's mercy.

Sayyeda Aisha said: Some Bedouin people came to the Prophet PBUH and said: Do you kiss your children? He said: Yes. He said: But we, by Allah, never kiss (our children). The Prophet PBUH said: What can I do if Allah has taken away mercy from you?" Sunan Ibn Maja:3668

Right of Respect

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has always treated children with respect and commanded us to do so.

عَنْ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ: أَكْرِمُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ وَأَحْسِنُوا أَدَبَهُمْ.

Do respect your children and teach them good morals. Sunan Ibn Maja:3671

Right of Inducing confidence

Allah the Almighty has guided us through the teachings of his Apostles that parents should induce confidence in their children. They should discuss matters with them, ask and respect their opinion. Parents should never rebuke and scold them just because they are small. When parents will call them with respect and guide them while taking care of their self-esteem only then children will be able to become emotionally strong. They will be able to face the challenges of the world. Allah the Almighty has mentioned the conversation of Hazrat Ibrahim PBUH and Hazrat Ismael PBUH before the remarkable sacrifice. Hazrat Ibrahim PBUH told him about the commandment of Allah and then ask his opinion in this regard.

فَلَمَّا بَلَغَ مَعَهُ السَّعْيَ قَالَ يَابْنَئِي إِنِّي أَرَى فِي الْمَنَامِ أَنِّي أَذْبَحُكَ فَانْظُرْ مَاذَا تَرَى قَالَ يَا أَبَتِ افْعَلْ مَا تُؤْمَرُ سَتَجِدُنِي إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ مِنَ الصَّابِرِينَ

پھر جب وہ (اسماعیل علیہ السلام) ان کے ساتھ دوڑ کر چل سکنے (کی عمر) کو پہنچ گیا تو (ابراہیم علیہ السلام نے) فرمایا: اے میرے بیٹے! میں خواب میں دیکھتا ہوں کہ میں تجھے ذبح کر رہا ہوں سو غور کرو کہ تمہاری کیا رائے ہے۔ (اسماعیل علیہ السلام نے) کہا: ابا جان! وہ کام (فوراً) کر ڈالیے جس کا آپ کو حکم دیا جا رہا ہے۔ اگر اللہ نے چاہا تو آپ مجھے صبر کرنے والوں میں سے پائیں گے

Then when (Isma'il [Ishmael]) reached (the age of) the ability to run about with him, Ibrahim (Abraham) said: 'O my son, I have seen in a dream that I am sacrificing you. So think, what is your opinion? Isma'il (Ishmael) said: 'O my father, do that (immediately) which you are being commanded. If Allah wills, you will find me among the patient (and steadfast).' (Sura Saffat: 37-52)

Here we are just focusing on the underline point. This act shows us how necessary it is to ask children their opinion and discuss issues with them.

Right to Justice

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has guided the parents to be very careful while distributing gifts among your children. All the distributions should be done with justice. The following hadith will elucidate the concept.

Narrated An-Numan bin Bashir g: that his father took him to Allah's Apostle a and said, "I have given this son of mine a slave." The Prophet PBUH asked, "Have you given all your sons the like?" He replied in the negative. The Prophet PBUH said, "Take back your gift then." Sahih Bukhari:2856

Right to Inheritance

Islam has also provided the right of inheritance to children. The details of this concept have been mentioned in Sur al-Nisa verse 11-12 and several hadiths.

Rights of Orphans

In Islam, orphans hold a special status, and there are specific guidelines and rights established for their care and well-being. These rights are derived from the teachings of the Quran and the Sunnah (the practices and sayings of the Prophet Muhammad, peace be upon him). Here are some of the key rights of orphans in Islam:

Protection of Wealth:

Orphan's wealth should be preserved and protected. It is not permissible to misuse or misappropriate their property. The guardian (usually a close relative) is responsible for managing and safeguarding their assets.

"Indeed, those who devour the property of orphans unjustly are only consuming into their bellies fire. And they will be burned in a Blaze." Surah An-Nisa (4:10)

Corruption in Orphan's wealth is strictly prohibited

Allah the Almighty has declared this as one of the biggest sins. One can understand the concept by comparing two verses. Allah has commanded to refrain fornication strictly.

وَلَا تَقْرُبُوا الزَّيْنَىٰ إِنَّهُ كَانَ فَاحِشَةً وَسَاءَ سَبِيلًا

And do not even go near unlawful sex (adultery).

وَلَا تَقْرُبُوا أَمْالَ الْيَتَامَىٰ إِلَّا بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ حَتَّىٰ يَبْلُغَ أَشُدَّهُ

And do not (also) go near the orphan's property but in a way that is beneficial (to the orphan) until he reaches his maturity.

One can see that the Lord of all humanity has declared these two sins prohibited with same intensity. In today's word we do consider adultery as a sin but corruption is not considered as a sin even our community don't even bother this. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH has mentioned this point in the following hadith.

The Prophet Muhammad PBUH said, “Avoid the seven great destructive sins. The people enquire, “O Allah’s Apostle PBUH! What are they? “He said, to join others in worship along with Allah, to practice sorcery, to kill the life which Allah has forbidden except for a just cause, (according to Islamic law), to eat up Riba (usury), to eat up an orphan’s wealth, to give back to the enemy and fleeing from the battlefield at the time of fighting, and to accuse, chaste women, who never even think of anything touching chastity and are good believers.

Fair Treatment:

Orphans should be treated with kindness, compassion, and fairness. They should not be subjected to any form of discrimination or injustice.

“And worship Allah and associate nothing with Him, and to parents do good, and to relatives, orphans, the needy, the near neighbor, the neighbor farther away, the companion at your side, the traveler, and those whom your right hands possess. Indeed, Allah does not like those who are self-deluding and boastful.” Surah An-Nisa (4:36)

Provision of Basic Needs:

The guardian is responsible for providing for the basic needs of the orphan, including food, clothing, shelter, education, and healthcare. The Prophet Muhammad has announced the glad tiding of highest rank to the person who takes care of an orphan.

“I and the guardian of the orphan will be in Paradise like this,” and he held his two fingers together.” Sahih Bukhari:5304

In another hadith same essence has been mentioned in the following words.

Allah’s Messenger PBUH said: One who looks after the orphan whether he is his relative or not, I and he would be together in Paradise like this, and Malik (explained it) with the gesture by drawing his index finger and middle finger close together. Sahih Muslim:7469

Educational and Financial Support:

Orphans should be given access to education and opportunities for personal development. Providing them with a good education is a crucial aspect of fulfilling their rights.

Emotional Support and Compassion:

Orphans should be shown love, care, and emotional support. They may have experienced trauma and loss, and it is important to provide them with a stable and nurturing environment. Allah the Almighty has guided us to never be harsh with an orphan by commanding His Prophet Muhammad a.

So, never should you be strict with any orphan, Sura Waduha:9

Rebuking Orphans is negation of Religion

Allah the Almighty has categorically mentioned in the Qur’an that any person who misbehaves with an orphan is like the one who negates the whole religion. He further added that the rituals of these persons will never be accepted.

“Have you seen him who denies Din (Religion)?

So, he is the one who pushes away the orphan (i.e. rejects the needs of the orphans and deprives them of their right),

And does not promote the cause of feeding the poor (i.e. does not strive to end the economic exploitation of the poor and the needy).

So, woe to those worshippers, Who are unaware of (the spirit of) their Prayers (i.e. they are mindful only of the rights of Allah but are heedless of the rights of fellow human beings),” Sura al-Maon 1-5

Guardianship with Consent:

If an orphan has reached an age of maturity, their opinion and consent should be sought when appointing a guardian.

Hadith of the Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him): “The consent of an orphan should be sought as much as possible with regard to his property, and his consent is taken if he is mature enough, otherwise the orphan's property is entrusted to a reliable person.”

Avoiding Exploitation:

Orphans should not be exploited for personal gain, and their rights should not be violated in any way.

These are some of the key rights of orphans in Islam, based on the teachings of the Quran and the Sunnah. It is important for the Muslim community to uphold and protect the rights of orphans, as their well-being and proper upbringing are highly emphasized in Islamic teachings.

Best Home in the sight of Allah

In a hadith the Holy Prophet Muhammad PBUH mentioned the virtue of orphan’s brought-up in a home. The Prophet Muhammad PBUH said:

“The best house among the Muslims is a house in which there is an orphan who is treated well. And the worst house among the Muslims is a house in which there is an orphan who is treated badly.” Sunan Ibn Maja:3679

Virtues of striving for an orphan and widow

One can comprehend the status of a person in the sight of Allah who is making efforts for an orphan and widow. The person who is trying to make their life easy in every manner.

“One who makes efforts (for earning to be spent) on a widow and the destitute is like a striver in the cause of Allah, and I think he also said: He is like one who constantly stands for prayer and observes fast without breaking it.” Sahih Muslim:7468

Rights of Minorities in an Islamic Society

Foundational Principles: Justice and Coexistence

Freedom of Religion:

Islam forbids forcing anyone to accept its faith.

“There is no compulsion in religion.” (Al-Baqarah 2:256)

Ensures religious freedom for non-Muslims under Muslim governance.

Universal Justice:

Islam commands fairness and justice toward all, regardless of religion or background.

“Do not let the hatred of a people prevent you from being just.” (Al-Ma'idah 5:8)

“When you judge between people, judge with justice.” (An-Nisā 4:58)

The Covenant of Protection: Ahl-uz-Zimmah

Definition:

Ahl al-Dhimmah (People of the Covenant) refers to non-Muslims who live under Islamic rule and accept its political authority.

In return, they receive full protection for their lives, property, and religious freedom.

A. Rights and Protections for Minorities

Right to Life and Security:

Their lives are sacred and protected.

The Prophet ﷺ said: “Whoever kills a non-Muslim citizen (Mu'ahid) will not smell the fragrance of Paradise.” (Sahih al-Bukhari)

Right to Practice Religion:

Freedom to worship and maintain their places of worship (churches, synagogues, temples).

Allowed to follow their own religious laws regarding family, inheritance, and personal matters.

Right to Property and Commerce:

They can own property, conduct business, and engage freely in trade.

Their wealth is protected except for the specific tax (Jizya).

Community Autonomy:

Non-Muslim communities may manage their internal affairs under their own leaders and religious authorities.

B. Responsibilities and the Jizya Tax**Definition:**

A yearly tax paid by able-bodied, non-Muslim men who are not required to serve in the military.

Purpose:

Political Loyalty: Symbolizes acceptance of the Islamic state's authority.

Protection and Exemption: Grants protection and exempts Dhimmis from military service.

Collection Guidelines:

Must be collected fairly and without oppression.

Amount should match the person's financial ability.

Caliph Umar ibn al-Khattab is known for ensuring justice and fairness in its collection.